Excavation of Glitterhold Gallery

A Simple Dungeon Exploration for 1st & 2nd Level parties of four

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The Monster Manual is required to run this adventure.
All bolded creature names are indexed in Appendix A.

Excavation of Glitterhold Gallery

Synopsis

The party must delve into the bowels of a vault constructed by a long dead Elf noble to house his treasures. As soon as they breach its gates, the characters must contend with the ancient security measures and vault denizens vying for control of their once sealed eco-system.

Adventure Hook

An archaeologist recruits the party for aid after her excavation team proclaims the site of her most recent discovery is cursed.

Adventure Background

Aeman Glitterhem, so named because of the gold and gems he had woven into all of his clothing, was one of the wealthiest nobles of the fallen elven empire of Illefarn. Unlike his contemporaries who flaunted their wealth by throwing lavish, weeks long galas or commissioning sprawling mansions with impossible architecture, Lord Glitterhem preferred to collect treasures and trinkets. Appropriating an ancient dwarven site, Aeman had it converted to an underground gallery and vault that he could use to show off and protect his treasures. Admission was by invitation only and by all surviving accounts was incredibly coveted.

History did not record Aeman's fate or that of his treasures, but it's been whispered by scholars and treasure hunters for centuries that his gallery sits ready to be rediscovered. **Zava Deepcups**, a young archaeologist, believes she has located the site after years of painstaking research. Unfortunately, after a member of her excavation crew was founded nearly strangled to death, the rest of the expedition declared the site cursed and refused to do any further work. Reaching out to her contacts in nearby cities, she has recruited the party to assist in her excavation and has promised a fair share of any treasures (as long as they aren't of any historical significance.)

Zava Deepcups

Daughter of a Drow father and Orc mother, Zava's heritage has given her a unique insight into the history and development of the Sword Coast and Undermountain

She is about 30 years old, tall, with pale green skin, closely cropped white hair and short tusks protruding from behind her bottom lip. Her eyes are gray.

- **Lawful Good**
- **Ideal:** "The world's secrets will be the footnotes of my legacy."
- **Flaw:** "The past makes more sense to me than the present."

Chapter 1: The Hanged Scholar

It's been about a days ride to the site criers have dubbed Aeman's Hill. From the distance it's an unassuming hill, no different from the other mounds surrounding it, but as you get closer it's easy to see where overgrowth and grass have been removed, revealing some sort of domed structure built into the countryside. You were told you'd be meeting your contact, Dr. Sava Deepcups, at the base of the tallest tree at the foot of the hill. The tree is hard to miss but you don't see anyone.

Behind a short crystalline fence stands a 15 ft tall tree that's a mess of vines, branches and thorns. A **DC 10 Survival** check will reveal that the tree is not native to the area while a **DC 10 Arcana** check will show that the "tree" is a **Shambling mound** whose growth has been manipulated by some magical means.

If the players search the area immediately around the "tree" they will find a pair of glasses, a compass, short sword and a few writing quills.

Any character near the base of the Shambling Mound will hear faint cries for help.

Sava has been ensnared by the Shambling mound and is dangling upside down in its vines. She is fighting valiantly to free herself but without a weapon she stands little chance of cutting herself loose.

Any amount of damage done to the Shambling Mound will be enough to cause it to release Sava. Before she gets her bearings she will aggressively prevent the party from doing any further damage to the mound and usher them away from it as quickly as possible.

"I'm sorry, it's just that sculpted arcano-flora like this was always considered theoretical, I'd hate to miss out on the chance to study this..." Sava will trail off before remembering her manners and formally introducing herself to the party.

"Dr. Sava Deepcups, at your service. And you've just met the reason I needed some hired help on this dig. Not sure what other surprises are in store."

Whether the players are interested or not Sava will give them the abridged history of Aeman Glitterhem from the adventure background while leading them up an overgrown stone path to the top of the hill.

Aeman's Hill

The top of the hill is overgrown with grass and weeds. A **DC 12 Intelligence (Nature)** check will reveal that the grass weeds have grown over some sort of ancient masonry. Beneath the weeds are four pedestals with a blade shaped sheath in each of the cardinal directions. If four swords are placed in each pedestal, the hill will unlock and a staircase will be revealed in the center. Sava will gladly provide the blades - all equipment left behind by the crew that deserted her.

> "Fascinating. I've read about these but never seen a working one. Supposedly the ancient Elves devised various tricks and puzzles that required their guests disarm themselves as a show of good faith..."

The staircase descends into a stone pit with a large wooden door against the wall. A skeleton is draped across the bottom step.

The door is a slab covered in faded glyphs. A successful **DC 12 Arcana** check will allow a character to identify them as being part of a warding glyph. The glyph will dissipiate if any spell 1st level or higher is cast on the door.

If the party is stumped, Sava will remind them of the Elven penchant for making their guests sacrifice something.

If the party lacks the ability or desire to cast any spells first level or higher, Sava will produce a battered **Wand of Magic Missiles**. She will expend its only remaining charge firing at the door, causing it to open.

Chapter 2: Welcome to Glitterhold

The ornate door leads into a marble hallway lined with **five** ornate paintings. There is another wooden door at the end of the hall.

Each painting depicts the same man, a bronze skinned, handsome Elf with loc'd hair down to his shoulders, in various outfits and locations. In one painting he is astride a warhorse while in another he's standing triumphant over slain Goblins. Sava will identify the figure as Aeman Glitterhem and begin furiously sketching his various depictions in her notebook.

The title of each painting is embossed on a golden plate underneath each image.

Aeman's Portraits

- **Aeman on the Shore**
- **Aeman vs the Goblins**
- **Aeman leads the Charge**
- **Aeman's Passion**
- **Aeman lost in Thought**
- **Aeman at the end of the World**

Any character with a **Passive Perception** greater than 15 or who passes a **DC 14 Investigation** check will notice that Aeman's eyes in each paiting appear to be moving.

The sixth plate, *Aeman at the end of the World*, does not have a painting hanging above it.

The door at the end of this hallway resembles the one used to enter the gallery, but it lacks the warding glyphs and features a standard door knob. It is unlocked.

The Lobby

The door leads into a large lounge area with marble floors, velvet couches and metallic racks of books and scrolls. In the center of the room is sturdy hardwood desk. Behind it sits a **Skeleton** (uses the *Commoner* stat block). On the far end of the room is a bronze door with round handles and two glass panes.

Tiffany Greenbranch

In life, Tiffany was a scholar and hoped to be a museum curator one day. He was unaware that when he accepted this position it would be a lifetime appointment. Or that it extended into his afterlife.

- **Lawful Neutral**
- **Bond:** "Gary was great to talk to. Wonder what happened to him."
- **Flaw:** "I never really lived when I was alive."

Despite his displeasure at his forced eternal life, Tiffany is compelled to attend to his duties as greeter for the gallery. He has no problem describing the layout of the gallery *as it was originally designed* and providing the party with a folded pamplet featuring a map. See **Appendix D** for the Gallery Map.

- **Level 1:** A1 & A2 Special Exhibitions
- **Level 2:** B3 Menagerie, B4 Children's Area
- **Level 3:** C5 & C6 Library
- **Level 4:** D7 Hall of Weapons, D8 Portrait Gallery

Tiffany will gladly detail the contents of each level of the gallery.

- *"The Special Exhibition? A look at food consumed by the kingdoms above and the kingdoms below. Master Glitterhem has an extensive collection of spices and mushrooms."*
- *"The Master's exotic pets are on level 2, plus a waiting area for any young ones."*
- *"Never let it be said that Aeman Glitterhem only valued shiny things. His collection of books is one of the finest on this side of the world."*

- *"And finally on level 4 you may visit Master Glitterhem's special weapons collection. The portrait gallery is unfortunately undergoing some maintenance."*

Sava will urge the party to head deeper into the gallery as she remains in the lobby to interview Tiffany. She doesn't want to pass up a chance to to interview someone with firsthand experience of a little documented historical figure.

The Lift

The Gallery's Lift is hexagonal contraption made of bronze. It features two identical doors with porthole windows on opposite ends of the lift. A panel in the center of the device features several buttons that correspond to levels of the gallery.

Note 1: If the players did not speak to Tiffany and recieve a pamplet, they will not know which buttons correspond to what levels. The party is free to visit any level of the gallery they wish.

Note 2: If Sava was unable to stop the party from destroying the Shambling Mound at the base of the hill, the lift will be completely out of order - smashed to pieces at the bottom of the shaft. The party can climb from floor to floor with a **DC 15 Athletics** check for every level and a **DC 12 Strength** check to open any gallery doors.

- **L:** Lobby
- **A:** Special Exhibitions
- **B:** Menagerie, Children's Area
- **C:** Library
- **D:** Hall of Weapons, Portrait Gallery

1st Floor - Exhibit Room

An exquisite dining hall with a table setting fit for a royal feast. An enchanted Magic Mouth spell cast on the table explains that this was Aeman Glitterhelm's famed "Feast of 10 Moons," magically replicated and preserved.

The spell replicating and preserving the food has begun to fail. Any item of food removed from the table has a 1 in 6 chance of a being perfectly preserved. All other items will have rotted or deteriorted in some way.

An ornate mirror covers the lenth of the wall along the table. A **DC 15 Perception** check will allow a character to notice that the reflection in the mirror doesn't perfectly align with the room. Utensils are arranged differently, and creatures reflected differ slightly from their actual selves.

1st Floor - Myconid Fellowship

This room is a near perfect replica of an Undermountain cavern.

The room is dank and humid. Plant matter, dirt and books are scattered over the room covered in mushroom sporlings. The far side of the room opens up into a cavern. This room originally exhibited food that Aeman had sampled while dining with Drow artistocrats.

A group of **20 Myconid**, **1 Myconid Sovereign** and **1 Myconid Inventor** sit around the room in small groups.

Like in the other exhibition room, the spell preserving the food in this room also began to fail. This allowed the mushrooms (both in the cavern and on the dinner table) to begin to spore. Eventually, a sentient colony of **Myconids** was born from the exhibit and has made their home in this room for countless generations.

The Myconids generally live an idyllic existence, they spend most of their time joined together a telepathic link. If approached with kindness, curiosity and respect, they will respond well to the party.They will share any information they know about the gallery and it's dangers, but the Myconid Inventor will take the lead in interacting with the party.

Myconid Inventor

A savant. He yearns to explore the world outside of their cave and create with wild abandon

- **Chaotic Good**
- **Ideal:** "If I can dream it, I should built it."
- **Flaw:** "Sometimes my inventions have unforseen consequences - that's just the price of science."

Myconid History will be shared telepathically with the party if they strike up a good accord with the Myconid fellowship:

> "We lived in the darkness for ages until we were discovered by the peace keeper. He showed us how to translate the books in the library below and the information within them transformed our minds. But it also taught our youth of violence and conquest.
>
> Armed with stories of knights seeking treasure and knowledge of the place where we exist, they travelled down deeper into the gallery seeking powers that might allow us to expand our dominion here. They found the war they wanted in the depths of this place, against a terrible creature"

Any player with profiencey in **Arcana** in the psychic link can make a DC 10 check to know that it's a **Minotaur**.

> "For years those of our children who fancied themselves warriors would seek out this monster, armed either with weapons pilfered from other part of the gallery or created with knowledge from the library below. None were able to best it - and even when death took the creature naturally it rose from the dead to carry on its duty."

The Myconid have spent years curbing the warlike desires of their young and have not encountered the Minotaur in many years.

Remodeling: The rear wall of the Myconid's replica cavern has been knocked out allowing them to slightly expand into a small cavern dug into the earth. This was accomplished through the use of **fungal explosives** developed by the Inventor. Their research was banned after this incident. This cavern serves as the Inventor's fungal laboratory.

Trouble with the neighbors: Unfortunately, after being emboldened with the success of the Myconid habitat expansion, the **Myconid Inventor** tried to expand another area of the gallery. This attempt at burrowing beyond the library on the 3rd level awoke a pack of **Eastern Spotted Aurumvoraxes** - small, ferocious mammals that consume precious gems and metals.

The presence of these creatures on the third level has made it unsafe for young Myconids to utilize the library.

> "Our Soverign has forbidden us from harming them, but you seem like you could make short work of the varmints."

The Inventor makes the party an offer: If the **Aurumvoraxes** are exterminated they will hand over a weapon they developed to defeat the **Minotaur** but have been forbidden to use.

The Myconid Inventor's Secret Weapon: Acid Spore - Stats as a as Gas Spore with its death burst damage replaced with *Sporic Acid*. No save is made and creatures within range automatically suffer lingering damage that weakens their defenses. The target's AC is reduced by 3 and weapon attacks made against them have advantage.

The Acid Spore is essentially a semi-biological balloon, string and all. It can be carried like any other balloon and be moved by any powerful gusts of wind or force.

Friendly Faces: The Myconid once had a strong bond with the gallery's securty guard, Gary, but they have not seen him for many generations.

2nd Floor – Menagerie Room

This room once housed the gallery's menagerie, a collection of rare creatures from around the world adored by Lord Glitterhem. At some point in the last thousand years, an infant Gelatinous Cube escaped its tank. Consuming the other creatures and objects in the menagerie, the **Gelatinous Cube** has expanded to gargatuan size. It now now fills the entire room.

Take note of the Cube's *Transparent* ability. Any party member who opens the lift door and attempts to enter the area must take a **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check or fail to notice the Cube.

If the party spots the cube: They can spend a few minutes observing the creature bones and fixtures floating around in its gel. Sights might include d12 electrum coins and a unicorn skull. The gel is also home to another Skeleton - the Gallery's security guard, Gary. Like Tiffany, he is also cursed with eternal life. Any party member who is psionic or telepathic can feel rage and pain radiating from Gary's mind.

As long as the cube is not attacked or the players do not otherwise call attention to themselves, it will remain motionless.

If the party fails to spot the cube: The Cube will begin entering the lift. Have the party roll initiative. It will take 3 of the Cube's turns for it to move enough of its mass into the lift to begin expanding into the space. Once the ooze begins filling the lift the party must either exit the lift through the bottom or top maintenance hatches. It will take a **DC 12 Athletics** for a character to open either hatch and lift themselves up or hang underneath the lift. Any character with profiecicy in Tinker or Thieve's tools can automatically open either latch.

Once the Cube has filled the lift its weight will cause the lift to plummet to the bottom of the shaft. The entirety of the cube is pulled down to the bottom of the shaft with it and it will be killed in the fall.

Any character who passed their Athletics check and climbed to the top of lift is able to hold ont the lift cable while the lift plummets. Characters underneath the lift will suffer fall damage and acid damage from the cube. They are unlikely to survive.

The Cube-less Menagerie: The party can explore the former menagerie room once the cube is dead. It is devoid of objects and contains only Gary, the mad skeleton. He is likely to attack the party on sight, especially if any members are elves.

Gary Hilldrift

Years trapped in the Gelatinous Cube, undying, have driven Gary mad and unlocked his latent psionic potential.

- **Ideal:** Revenge. Death's sweet embrace.
- **Bond:** The Myconids, Tiffany.

Gary's location: Whenever the party enters a new area, roll below to determine Gary's location in the gallery.

1 - Menagerie: Gary will weep. All telepathic creatures in the gallery must succeed on a **DC 10 Wisdom Saving Throw** or suffer 2d4 psychic damage.

2 - Kid's Area: Gary will remember a shadow of his former self. He will remove 1d6 **Goodberry Juiceboxes** from an extradimensional storage space and leave them on the table. Each restores 3 hit points.

3 - Library (1): Gary will set this area on fire.

4 - Library (2): Gary will claim the spell scroll if it is present.

5 - Hall of Weapons: Gary will don the **Bio-Boosting Mail** if it is present.

6 - Portrait Gallery: Gary will wait.

7 - Dining Room: Gary will destroy the mirror and burn the table

8 - Myconid Fellowship: Remembering his bond with their acnestors, the Mycnonids can temporarily calm Gary's rage.

Gary's Security Log

Gary's Security Logs can be found scattered across both libraries on the 3rd level.

- **Entry 10:** "It's been a week since Lord Glitterhem vanished. We still haven't managed to find a way out of the gallery."
- **Entry 25:** "Tiffany ate a poison mushroom in the Underdark Dining exhibit. By the time my tears had stopped flowing his body was mended and life restored. I think we might be in one of the nine hells..."
- **Entry 100:** "Sometimes I hear Aeman in my sleep. Even in my dreams that pompous ass berates me for help."
- **Entry 237:** "-ffany thinks I'm spending too much time with the mushroom sprouts, but they're a nice change of pace from his bad attitude. They're quick leaners and they love when I read them accounts of old battles."
- **Entry 258:** "Maybe I do read the shroomlings too many spooky stories. One of them told me they saw their reflection move on its own in the Dining Room."
- **Entry 399:** "I'm not really sure what else to do - Jezzie's just gotten too big for her tank. I think the only decent course of action is to put her out of her misery."

Gary, Acid Cured Revenant

Medium Undead, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 15 (spite)
Hit Points 13 (2d8 + 4)
Speed 35ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	5 (-3)

Damage Vulnerabilities Bludgeoning
Damage Resistances Slashing
Condition Immunities Poison, Sleep, Charm
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 20
Languages Telepathy
Challenge 1 (XP)

Cackle (Recharge 5-6). The creature casts *Tasha's Hideous Laughter* as a bonus action

Dauntless. As a reaction, the creature can psionically deflect one ranged attack targeting it that is not a critical hit

Immortal. When reduced to 0 hit points, the Revenant's remains vanish and it ressurects in another part of the gallery.

Pyrokinetic (Recharge 5-6). The creature casts *Produce Flame* as a bonus action

Actions

Acid-Edged Short Sword. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage. Attack has advantage if target is wearing Light or no armor.

2nd Floor – Kid's Area

A playroom designed for children. It is filled with bean bags, brightly colored furniture and various toys. The room is covered in muddy footprints, some made by Myconid youth, others by Aurumvoraxes.

The room is enchanted and grants immunity to bludgeoning, piercing, slashing, fall and magic damage to any creatures in the room.

This area has very specific rules written on the wall *in Elvish*:

- No fighting, No swearing, No being mean
- We always say we're sorry

Any creature who breaks a rule is sent to **time out:** an extradimensional void where they will remain until they apologize for their transgression. Beings in time-out can see and hear creatures in the room but cannot interact with them. A semi-sincere apology is the only way to leave time out.

Kid's Area Playthings

The toys in this area can all replicate the effect of a cantrip.

- **Magic Wand** - Prestidigitation
- **Sketch Box** - Encode Thoughts
- **Alchemy Station** - Acid Splash, damage capped at 1
- **Magic Glove** - Mage Hand

The party has a 1 in 4 chance of encountering an **Aurumvorax** when entering the room. The creature will be skittish but curious.

The Kid's Area has a bouncy staircase leading down into Library (2) on level 3.

3rd Floor – Library (1)

What was once a formidable collection of books has been reduced to a state of ruin, stinking of dung and fur. The room is littered with gnawed tomes and torn pages.

A **DC 15 Investigation** check reveals that the only books that were damaged seemed to have metallic bindings, covers, gilded pages or inlays that housed precious gems. The books made of more mundane (or less valuable) materials are mostly fine.

Any character with a proficiency in History, Arcana, Medicine or Religion can identify at least **1d4** first editions worth 75 GP after the room has been investigated.

The wall of the library has been exvavated into a small tunnel that leads to an Aurumvorax den. Activity in the room will alert the Aurumvorax who will emerge from their den.

Aurumvorax Den: Home of 1d6+2 **Aurumvorax**. The Aurumvorax will fight to death if attacked in their den, but will retreat into their den to escape death if fighting in the library.

Any Small-sized creature can fit into the Aurumvorax tunnel into their den.

Searching the den with a **DC 10 Investigation** check will reveal 200 GP in precious gems and a **Spell Scroll** containing a 1st level spell usable by a member of the party.

A tail or paw sliced from any of the creatures is enough to convince the Myconid Inventor their request has been fufilled. They will gladly hand over the Acid Spore.

3rd Floor – Library (2)

It is not possible to enter this room via the lift. A pile of boulders and rubble blocks the entryway.

This library is in a state of disarray. Despite taking care to prevent damage to the tomes, the Myconids who have used it for generations never quite learned the finer points of its organizational system. Spore covered books cover the tables, chairs and floors.

The books in this room are generally in good condition. Any character with a proficiency in History, Arcana, Medicine or Religion can identify at least **1d12** first editions worth 100 GP each after the room has been investigated with a **DC 12 Investigation** Check. Passing the check with a **16** or higher will allow the players to discover a **1st level Spell Scroll.**

Chapter 3: Into the Depths

4th Floor – Hall of Weapons

This room once housed Lord Glitterhem's collection of rare and exotic weapons. For the most part the room has been cleared out - if the party has encountered the Myconids, they will know that the weapons were mostly claimed by young Myconid warriors in their quest to defeat the Minotaur on the next level of the gallery. Only three pieces of the collection remain.

Each display case or rack is enchanted to give a brief history of the object and how it came into Glitterhem's possession.

- *Ray Gun* - A complicated energy weapon. Only functions when wielded by a Space Clown (See *Boo's Astral Menagerie* for more information.)
- *Quiver of Ehlonna* - See *Dungeon Master's Guide* pg 189
- *Bio-Boosting Mail* - Light Armor. AC +2. Living armor from beyond the stars.Can be worn over existing light armor. Increases Stregnth, Constitution & Dexterity by 2. Wearer must constume half its HP in life energy from living humanoids every 24 hours or suffer a level of exhaustion. **DC 17 Charisma Saving Throw** to remove armor once donned.

A velvet rope blocks off a staircase on the far side of the room. This leads down to the **Minotaur's Corridor**.

4th Floor – Portrait Gallery

The door to this area does not open automatically with the lift's. A **DC 15 Stregnth (Athletics)** test is required to pry open the doors. A faded piece of paper with the words CAUTION, UNDER MAINTENANCE scrawled in Elvish is pasted to the center of the doors.

This room is made of immaculately white marble. The two center walls feature four picture frames covered with velvet curtains. Behind the curtains, each frame houses an enchanted mirror. Whenever a mirror is uncovered, a new effect place in the room:

- **1st Mirror:** The hallucinatory terrain spell (save DC 15) affects the room.
- **2nd Mirror:** 1d4 **Reflections** of creatures in the gallery crawl from the mirrors and attack. See **Appendix C** for a detailed stat block.
- **3rd Mirror:** Gravity in the room will reverse for the player who uncovered the mirror and one additional party member chosen by the Dungeon Master.
- **4th Mirror:** One random creature in the region must succeed on a **DC 15 Dexterity** saving throw or be turned into living glass. They gain a weakness to bludgeoning and force damage. A glass creature will automatically fail its Wisdom saving throw if targted by the Glass Dragon's *Suggestion* spell.

If all four mirrors are uncovered, the party is transferred to a mirror realm, a magically inverted version of the gallery room. The mirror realm is the lair of a **Pellucdiara, Heir of Lucent Fangs** - a **Mirror Dragon**.

The dragon is intially more amused than hostile. It's been a long time since Aeman trapped it in the gallery, and even longer since it managed to turn the tables on him.

"I haven't had a new friend in so long"

If all four mirrors are destroyed, Aeman will be trapped in the mirror realm until a ritual is conducted during the full moon to repair the link between the two planes.

Pellucidiara, Heir of the Lucent Fangs

Tiny Mirror Dragon, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 15
Hit Points 30 (2d20 + 5)
Speed 10 ft., fly 60 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
3 (-4)	20 (+5)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Condition Immunities Charmed, Sleep
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages Draconic, Sylvan
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Mirroed Manuevers: The Mirror Dragon takes two actions per turn.

Innate Spellcasting. The dragon's innate spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 13). It can innately cast a number of spells, requiring no material components:

1/day each: bane, color spray, chromatic orb, hallucinatory terrain, mage hand, major image, mirror image, polymorph, reflective bolt (see *Appendix D*), suggestion

Limited Telepathy. Using telepathy, the dragon can magically communicate with any creature within its mirror realm.

Magic Resistance. The faerie dragon has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Shard Shower. The Glass Dragon can cast *Magic Missile* at-will as a 1st level spellcaster.

Superior Invisibility. As a bonus action, the dragon can magically turn invisible until its concentration ends (as if concentrating on a spell). Any equipment the dragon wears or carries is invisible with it.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* Melee Weapon Attack: +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. Hit: 1 piercing damage.

Euphoria Breath (Recharge 5–6). The dragon exhales a puff of euphoria gas at one creature within 5 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw, or for 1 minute, the target can't take reactions and must roll a d6 at the start of each of its turns to determine its behavior during the turn:

1–4. The target takes no action or bonus action and uses all of its movement to move in a random direction.

5–6. The target doesn't move, and the only thing it can do on its turn is make a DC 11 Wisdom saving throw, ending the effect on itself on a success

As long as Pellucidiara hasn't been attacked or belittled, a **DC 12 Charisma** check is all that's needed to begin getting into its good graces. If engaged in conversation the dragon will reveal several pieces of information:

Aeman's fate: Aeman trapped the dragon in the portrait gallery and considered it the crown jewel of his collection. After weeks of such indignity, the dragon tricked Aeman and trapped him within a mirror zone. He was its plaything for decades until the dragon grew bored of him. *"He's still wandering around here somewhere, I imagine..."*

Where it came from: The dragon will be playfully evasive but will reveal that it was trapped in this realm by Aeman when the Mirror Dimension it hailed from briefly intersected with this plane of existence. While it resents its bondage, it has no interest in returning to its home dimension while this one remains unconqured.

What it wants: Besides freedom, Pellucidiara wants what all dragons desire: power, adoration and a chance to grow its treasure hoard. Mirror Dragons covet *reflections* - they represent all of the potential of a creature, past and present.

Pellucidiara is willing to let the party go without a fight and free Aeman if a member of the party who isn't an Elf (*"I'm so bored of Elves"*) is willing to offer up its reflection as an offering for its hoard. If the players balk at this offer, it is time to roll initiative.

If the party takes the deal: The Dragon will greedily take the reflection of any party member who offers it. Any creature giving up its reflection automatically loses its Ideals, Bond and Flaw. It is not entirely a blank slate - all of its previous memories and experiences are still there, but the creature reacts to them the way someone would someone else's memories.

Like all dragons, Mirror Dragons are greedy. The ease which the party agreed to its terms has convinced it they would be easy prey. After savoring the taste of the party member's reflection it has claimed, Pellucidiara will initiate combat.

At the Dungeon Master's Discretion: a Reflectionless PC should be allowed to completely redetermine their character when they level up: give your player the option to choose new Bonds, Ideals & Flaws, but also have them consider leveling into a new class while ignoring any standard multiclass requirements.

If Pellucidiara is defeated: The party is returned to the portrait gallery, restored to the state it was in when they first entered. After a few moments, a confused, drowsy Elf in fancy garb will come stumbling into the room. This is **Aeman Glitterhem** (stats as a **Noble**.) He will thank the party for freeing him and reward them handsomely with the contents of the chest in the **Curator's Office**.

Aeman will take the information that he has been trapped for thousands of years in stride. He's proud to have outlived his rivals thanks to his wealth. He will immediately prepare to take stock of the gallery, get it in order and prepare to explore the brave new world he has woken up to. Go to the **Wrapping up the adventure** section for more on this.

Pellucidiara's Treasure Hoard

After Pellucidiara's defeat, a glass treasure chest containing her hoard will appear in the center of the portrait gallery. Aeman will not object to the party laying claim to it, but he will ask if it has his "favorite cup"

"A lover gifted that to me, I'm a bit sentimental. Gods above I guess he's been dead for a long time now hasn't he? Perhaps I'll look up his family. Thier blood always ran hot if you catch my meaning..."

2200 cp, 1100 sp, 100 gp, a bloodstone cup engraved with dwarven runes (25 gp), a bone orb inlaid with silver (25 gp), a rosewood rod inlaid with a filigree of silver (25 gp), a small woolen carpet (25 gp), an obsidian rod set with a single peridot (25 gp), a Spell Scroll (**Reflective Bolt**), 2 x Potion of Healing (common, dmg 187), **Pellucidiara's Vanity** *(See Appendix C)*

5th Floor – Minotaur's Corridor

This marble hallway is 10 feet wide with a 20 foot high ceiling. It appears to be about 60 feet long. The hall is littered with the rotted and sporing bodies of long fallen Myconids. Pieces of shattered weaponry lay strewn down the length of the hallway.

A large **Miotaur Skeleton** stands guard at the other end. A staircase sits in the right corner a few feet behind the minotaur. The Minotaur will attack any creatures who move down the hallway. Only the gallery's owner knows the password to calm the undead creature.

A **DC 17** Investigation check near the doorway will reveal a **+1 Weapon** of the DM's choice in the rotted muck of a fallen mushroom warrior.

6th Floor – Final Corridor

The staircase leads into a marble hallway identical to the one the party encountered when entering the gallery. It is decorated **five** ornate paintings. There is a large set of wooden doors at the end of the hall.

Each painting depicts the Aeman Glitterhem in various outfits and locations.

Aeman's Portraits

- **Aeman wins the Aarakockra Queen's Heart**
- **Aeman vs the Lich**
- **Aeman laughs over salad**
- **Aeman swims in the nude**
- **Aeman warns of the oncoming darkness**

If the party has not defeated the Mirror Dragon: Any character with a **Passive Perception** greater than 12 will notice that Aeman's depictions in each portrait appear to be in distress.

Only a spell or effect used to read thoughts or otherwise animate mundane objects, will allow Aeman to express that he's been trapped. He will beg the party to defeat the Mirror Dragon and offer them incredible rewards if they free him.

6th Floor – Curator's Office

The doors to the Curator's Office open easily. The office has been magically preserved - even the cup of tea on the desk still seems warm. The desk itself is covered in encoded magical research notes.

A successful **DC 16 Arcana** check will allow a party member to determine that Aeman had figured out how to trap an creature from another dimension - some sort of *"mirror realm"* - he believed this acquisition would allow him to become the true envy of his rivals. Any party member who reads the material must succeed on a **DC 15 Charisma** saving throw or the information will burrow its way into their mind.

Treasure Chest: 2000 Electrum pieces, a spellbook containing **1d4** 2nd level Spells approriate for a spellcaster in the party, a **Bag of Holding** and a **treasure map** to a location of the Dungeon Master's choice.

Concluding the adventure:

Whether the party cleared the dungeon of its dangers or freed its owner from his magical prison, they can report back to Sava that they have completed their task.

If Aeman was freed Sava will gladly spend the next few months interviewing him for his first hand experience of ancient Elven society.

Still grateful for their assistance, Aeman will offer to become the party's patron. He will pay them handsomely to ascertain the status of his old properties. He will also gladly provide the party with a list of old acquaintances and rivals - he'd love to know what became of them and how history remembered them, if at all.

If Gary has not been disposed of or otherwise incapcitated: He will accost the party in **The Lobby** and attempt to kill Aeman. If the party can protect Aeman, he will reveal to Gary and Tiffany that spell keeping them alive will end if they step foot outside of the gallery. Aeman will be incredibly apologetic about the position his servants have been in. Tiffany will be overjoyed but Gary will not care, only blood or a **DC 25 Persusasion** check will sate his rage.

If Aeman was not freed: Sava will thank the party for a job well done. Perhaps in her further exploration of the gallery she herself will end up in the Mirror Dragon's clutches.

Loose Ends & Potential Quest Hooks

The Missing Portrait - One of the portraits in the entranceway gallery is missing. What happened to it?

Knowledge of the Mirror Dimension - If a party member failed their save after reading the notes in the Curator's Office, they will feel compelled to spend their down time researching Moon phases and leyline placements. They will learn that during eclipses, the Mirror Dimension intersects with their plane and seek to call forth the powers that exist there.

Who or what are the Lucent Fangs? - Does Pellucidiara have some big bad extradimensional cousins? Only time will tell.

Myconid Exile - When the Myconid Sovereign discovers that the Inventor made a deal with the party to exterminate the Aurumvorax, the Inventor will be exiled. Perhaps they will seek out the party for aid and can be kept on as a retainer.

Glitterhold Staff - If the party accepts Aeman as a patron and chooses to make Glitterhold Vault their base of operations, the remodeled keep will require a staff to make full use of its facilities.

The Myconid Inventor is a prime candidate to tinker in the workshop & Sava Deepcups wouldn't object to using the library as a place to work on her book about this archaeological find.

Myconid Colony - Regardless of whether or not the party takes Glitterhold as a base of operations, Aeman will be kicking the Myconid off the top floor and remodeling the basement levels into a more suitable habitat for their colony.

The colony will provide convenient access to the Underdark and serve as a trade outpust. See the map in **Appendix D** for more information,

Appendix A – Encounter Reference

- Commoner - *Monster Manual pg 345*
- Gas Spore - *Monster Manual pg 138*
- Minotaur Skeleton - *Monster Manual pg 273*
- Noble - *Monster Manual pg 348*
- Myconid Adult - *Monster Manual pg 232*
- Myconid Sovereign - *Monster Manual pg 232*
- Shadows - *Monster Manual pg 269*
- Shambling mound - *Monster Manual pg 270*

Myconid Inventor

Medium Plant, Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)
Hit Points 22(4d8 + 4)
Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 11
Languages Telepathy
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Distress Spores. When the myconid takes damage, all other myconids within 240 feet of it can sense its pain.

Sun Sickness. While in sunlight, the myconid has disadvantage on ability checks, attack rolls, and saving throws. The myconid dies if it spends more than 1 hour in direct sunlight.

Fungal Research. With one week of down time and 1000 GP the Myconid Inventory can discover how to to grow mushrooms that allow those who ingest them to replicate the effects of the following cantrips: *Produce Flame*, *Poison Spray*, *Spare the Dying*, *Shocking Grasp*.

Actions

Fist. Melee Weapon Attack: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (2d4) bludgeoning damage plus 5 (2d4) poison damage.

Pacifying Spores (3/Day). The myconid ejects spores at one creature it can see within 5 feet of it. The target must succeed on a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or be stunned for 1 minute. The target can repeat the saving throw at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.

Rapport Spores. A 20-foot radius of spores extends from the myconid. These spores can go around corners and affect only creatures with an Intelligence of 2 or higher that aren't undead, constructs, or elementals. Affected creatures can communicate telepathically with one another while they are within 30 feet of each other. The effect lasts for 1 hour.

Weapon Invention. The Myconid uses one of the following options (roll a d8 or choose one); the Myconid can use each one no more than once per day:

1. Sporic Gas. Using a chimney blower connected to its body, the Myconid blasts puff of caustic spores. Each creature inside the cone must succeed on a DC 11 Dexterity saving throw or take damage. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, range 15 ft. cone. Hit: 7 (2d6) necrotic damage.

2. Fungal Explosive. The Myconid throws an explosive mushroom. Ranged Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, range 5/20 ft., one target. Hit: 3 (1d6) force damage.

3. Spider-Shroom. The Myconid throws a small mushroom into a 5-foot-square space within 20 feet of it. Functions at the ***Web*** spell (DC 13.)

4. Terra-Shroom. The Myconid throws a small mushroom into a 5-foot-square space within 20 feet of it. Functions as the ***Mold Earth*** cantrip.

Dr. Zava Deepcups

Large Fae, Neutral Good

Armor Class 16 (studded leather)
Hit Points 80(13d8 + 22)
Speed 35ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	18 (+4)	15 (+3)	17 (+4)	13 (+2)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Con +4, Wis +3

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9
Languages Elvish, Orcish, Dwarvish, Draconic, Gnomish

Fey Ancestry. Zava has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put Zava to sleep.

Actions

Wand of Magic Missiles. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 120ft. *Hit* (1d4 + 2)

Steel Toed-Boot. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +1 to hit, reach 5ft., one target. *Hit* 5 (1d6 + 2)

Acid Cured Revenant

Medium Undead, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 15 (spite)
Hit Points 13(2d8 + 4)
Speed 35ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	5 (-3)

Damage Vulnerabilities Bludgeoning
Damage Resistances Slashing
Condition Immunities Poison, Sleep, Charm
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 20
Languages Telepathy
Challenge 1 (XP)

Cackle (Recharge 5-6). The creature casts *Tasha's Hideous Laughter* as a bonus action

Dauntless. As a reaction, the creature can psionically deflect one ranged attack targeting it that is not a critical hit

Pyrokinetic (Recharge 5-6). The creature casts *Produce Flame* as a bonus action

Actions

Acid-Edged Short Sword. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage. Attack has advantage if target is wearing Light or no armor.

Spotted Eastern Aurumvorax

Small monstrosity, unaligned

Armor Class 11 (natural armor)
Hit Points 9(2d8)
Speed 35 ft, burrow 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	16(+3)	10 (+0)	2 (-4)	12 (+1)	5 (-3)

Condition Immunities Petrified,
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages None
Challenge 1/8 (25 XP)

Acid Mouthed. Armor successfully targeted by three bite attacks is permanently damaged. Its AC bonus is reduced by 1.

Pack Tactics. The Aurumvorax has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the Aurumvorax's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Tunneler. The aurumvorax can burrow through solid rock and metal at half its burrowing speed and leaves a 5-foot-diameter tunnel in its wake.

Actions

Multiattack. The aurumvorax makes one Bite attack and two Claw attacks.

Claws. Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage. If the target is a Medium or smaller creature, it is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, the aurumvorax can't use its Claw attack on another target, and when it moves, it can drag the grappled creature with it, without the aurumvorax's speed being halved.

Bite. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage. If the target is a creature wearing armor of any type, the aurumvorax regains 4 (1d6 + 1) hit points.

Appendix C - Magic Items & Spells

Reflective Bolt

2nd-level conjuration

Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Components: M (a reflective surface)
Duration: Instantaneous

A beam of crackling, white energy lances out from the spell's material component surface towards a creature within range. Make a ranged spell attack against that creature. On a hit, the target takes 1d8 radiant damage and **1d4 Reflections** of the target crawl from the reflective surface. They immediately become hostile towards the target and its allies.

Any reflective surface used as the material component of this spell is destroyed. A bladed weapon can only be used the material component for this spell if it is specifically polished during downtime and not used to make a melee weapon attack before this spell is cast.

Note: Characters who cast Reflective Bolt or copy it into their spellbooks must succeed on a DC 15 Charisma saving throw or be cursed with knowledge of the Mirror Dimension.

Pellucidiara's Vanity

Adventuring Gear (wondrous item)

A polished silver mirror encrusted with moonstone shards. While holding and looking into this mirror, you can cast the *Disguise Self* spell.

This item is **cursed.** If you do not use the mirror to end the effects of the *Disguise Self* spell before an hour has elapsed, you will be unable to return to your original form. The effect can only be reversed if the mirror is destroyed underneath a full moon at a place of power.

Otherworldly whispers can be heard emanating from this object after sundown. A character cursed with knowledge of the Mirror Dimension will be inexplicably drawn to these voices.

Note: Characters who use Pellucidiara's Vanity must succeed on a DC 15 Charisma saving throw or be cursed with knowledge of the Mirror Dimension.

Reflection

Medium Fae, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 12
Hit Points 16 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 35ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	6 (-2)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Skills Stealth +4

Damage Vulnerabilities Bludgeoning

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages None

Amorphous. The Reflection can move through a space as narrow as 1 inch wide without squeezing.

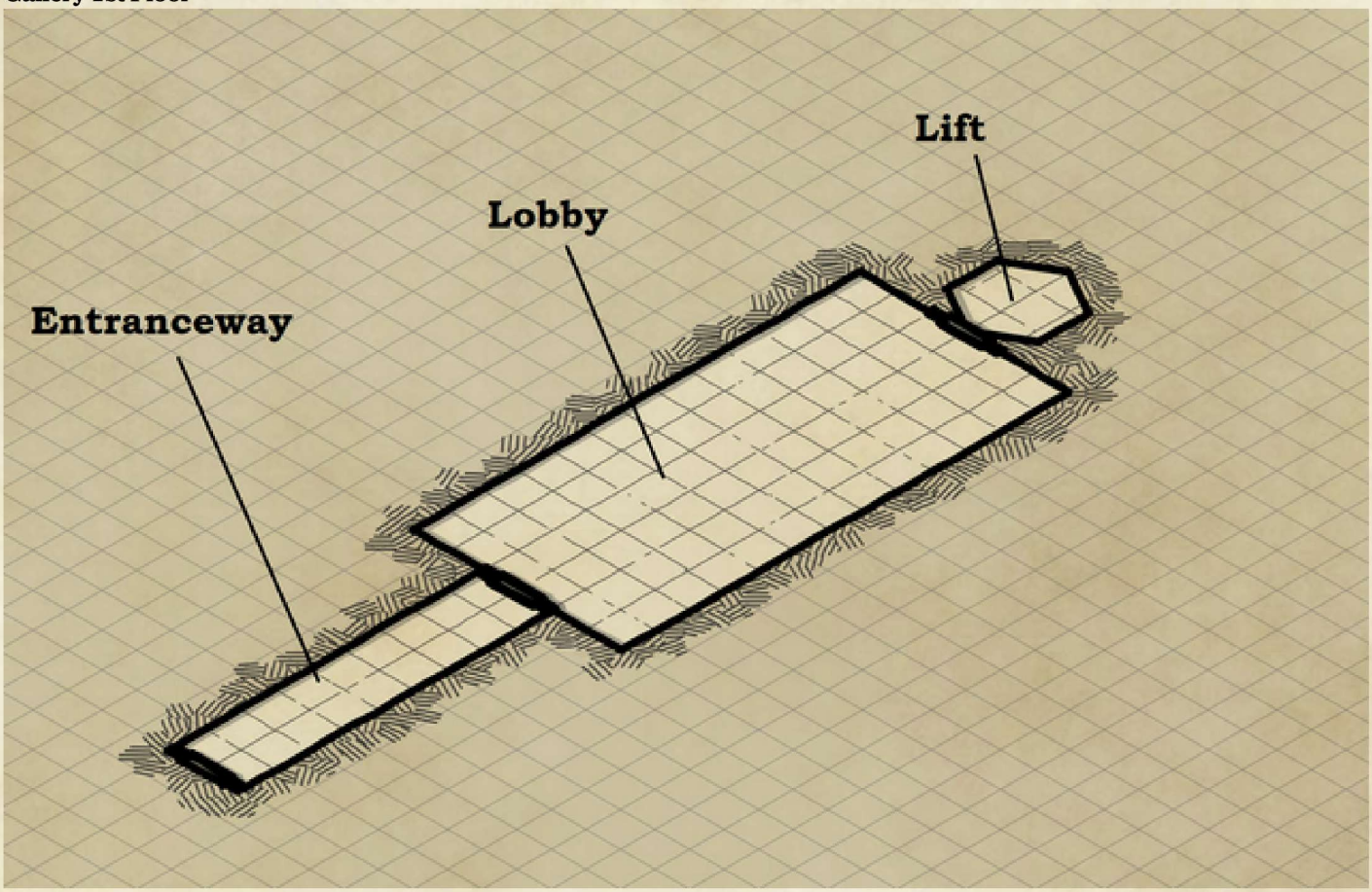
Actions

Strength Drain. Melee Weapon Attack: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. Hit: 9 (2d6 + 2) necrotic damage, and the target's Strength score is reduced by 1d4. The target dies if this reduces its Strength to 0. Otherwise, the reduction lasts until the target finishes a short or long rest.

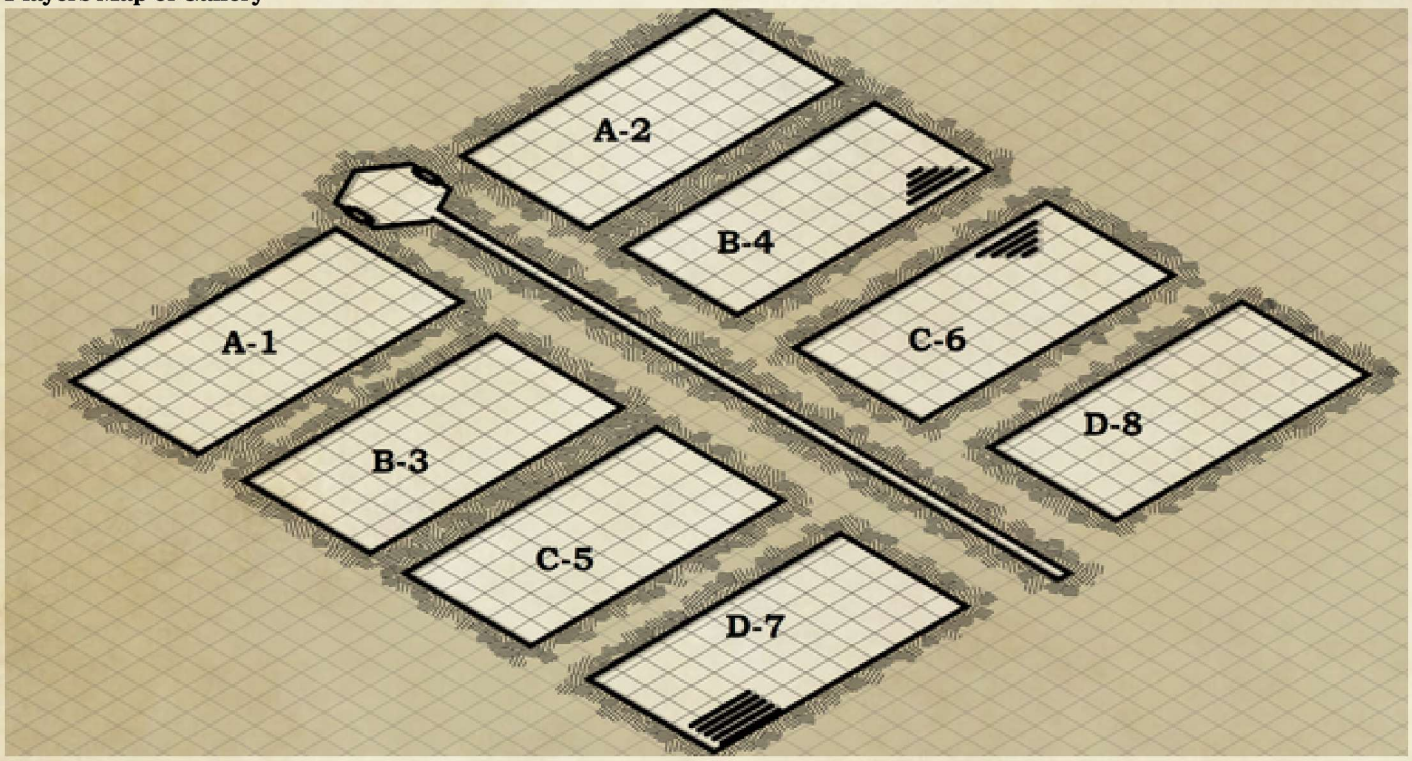
If a living humanoid dies from this attack, the Reflection that killed it absorbs its essence and takes on that creatures type. The now flesh & blood Reflection will use the **Commoner** stat block but will retain its creature type and Chaotic Evil alignment. Any active Reflections generated by this spell will immediately become hostile towards it.

Appendix D - Maps

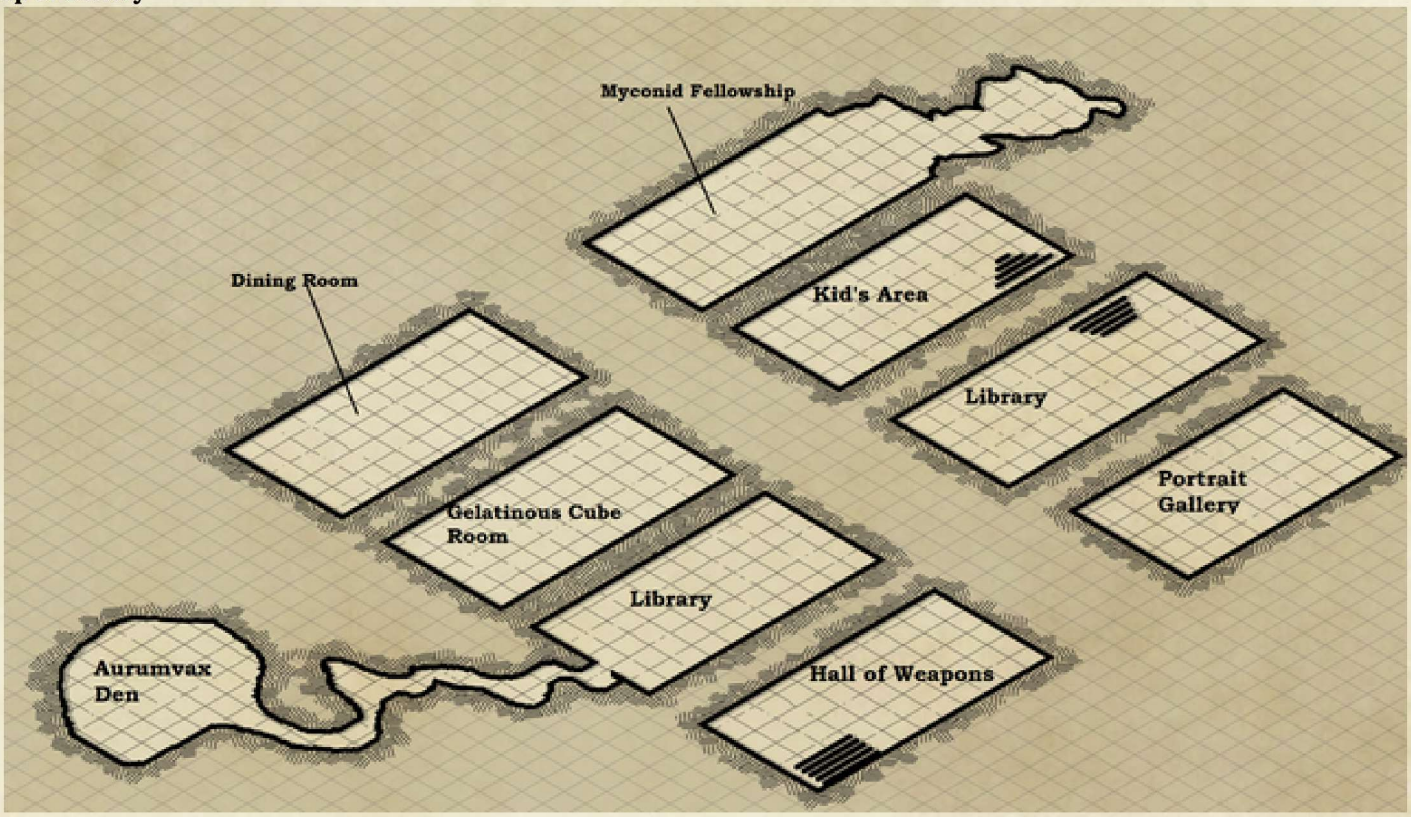
Gallery 1st Floor

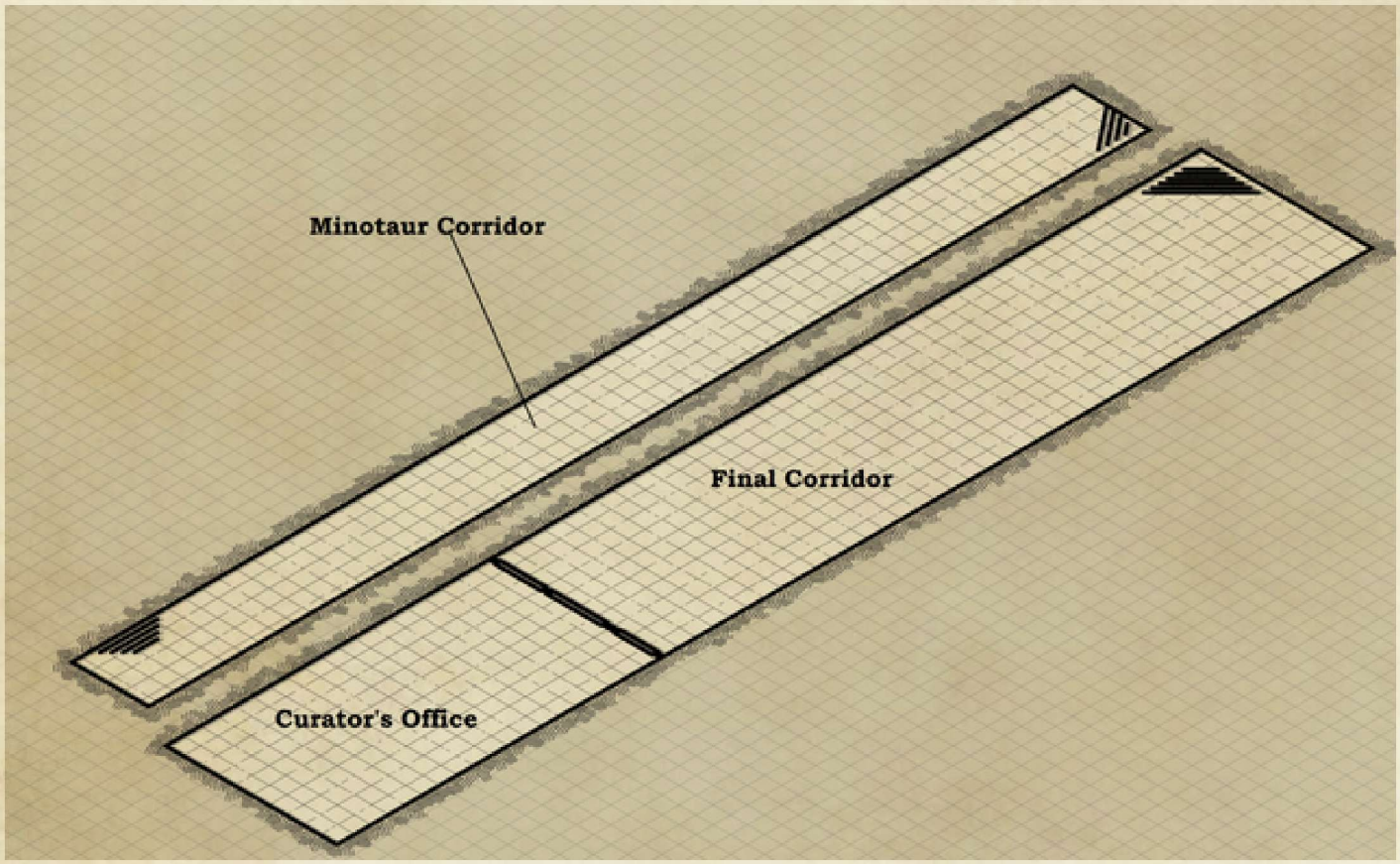


Players Map of Gallery



Map of Gallery





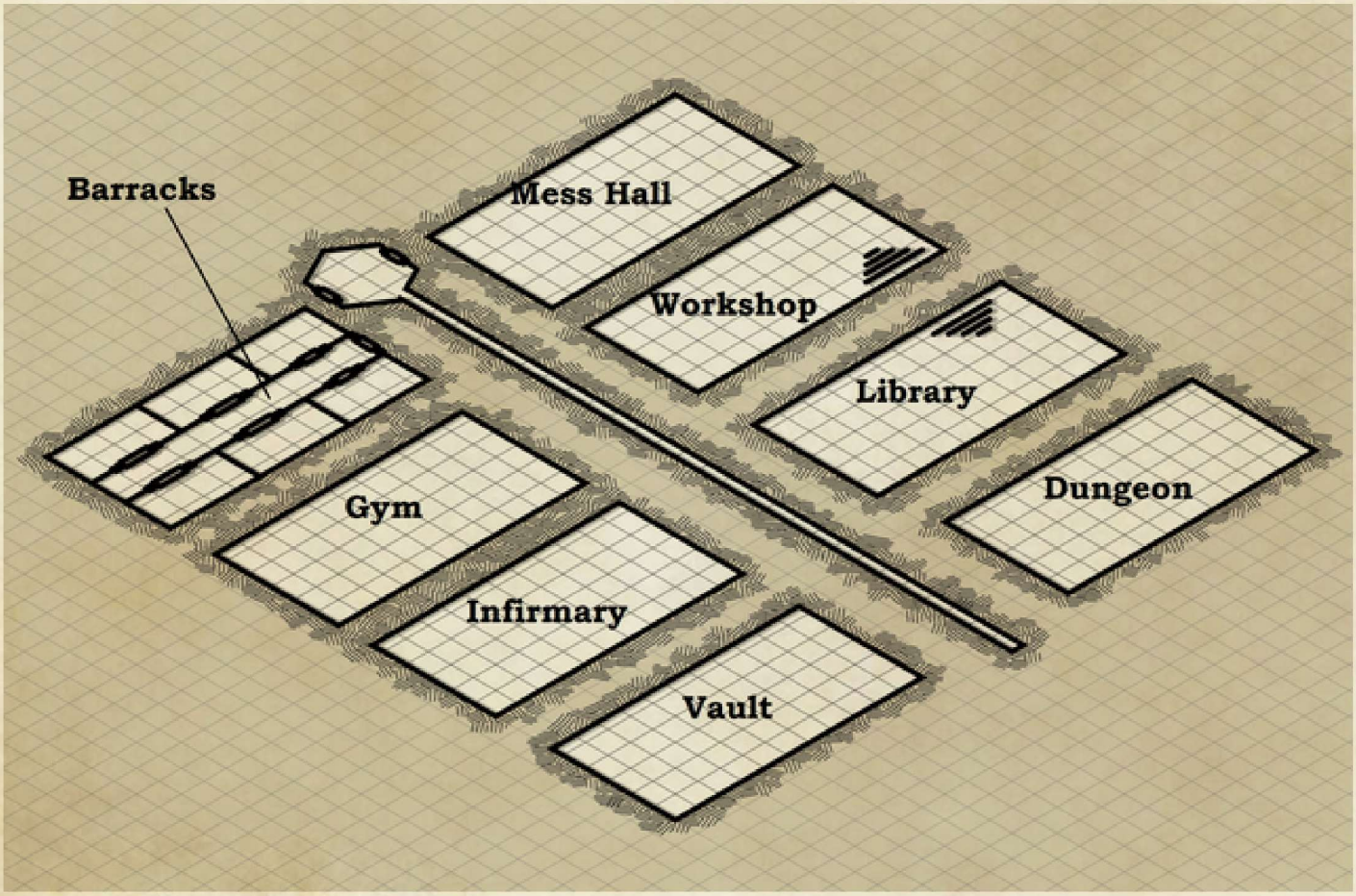
Map of Player Base

Glitterhold Vault

If the party accepts Aeman as their patron, he will gladly convert the gallery into a base of operations for them as he seeks out more luxurious accomondations in a nearby major city.

All magical spells previously effecting the space have been dispelled and the rooms have been remodeled to suit the needs of an adventuring party.

- **Barracks:** *"I suppose the rooms could've been bigger."*
- **Mess Hall** *"I'm not exactly sure what is required for cooking. I took a swing."*
- **Gym** *"I get all my exercise in the bedroom but I'm sure this will get the job done."*
- **Workshop:** *"I cannot imagine why you'd make what you could simply buy but adventures seem so po-uhhhhhh-hands on in this era."*
- **Infirmary** *"Lets hope you don't need this. Can't see it being much use without a doctor..."*
- **Library:** *"I updated the collection but kept a few classics."*
- **Vault:** *"This safe was impenetrable back in my day. I'm sure safecracking hasn't advanced that much."*
- **Dungeon:** *"Do keeps and lairs not have dungeons anymore? I'm not up on the latest design trends."*



Map of Myconid Colony

Myconid Colony

"Between the two of us I just had to get them out of Glitterhold. They made everything so damp and noxious. This is much better - so many business oppurunities with a direct foothold into the Underdark."

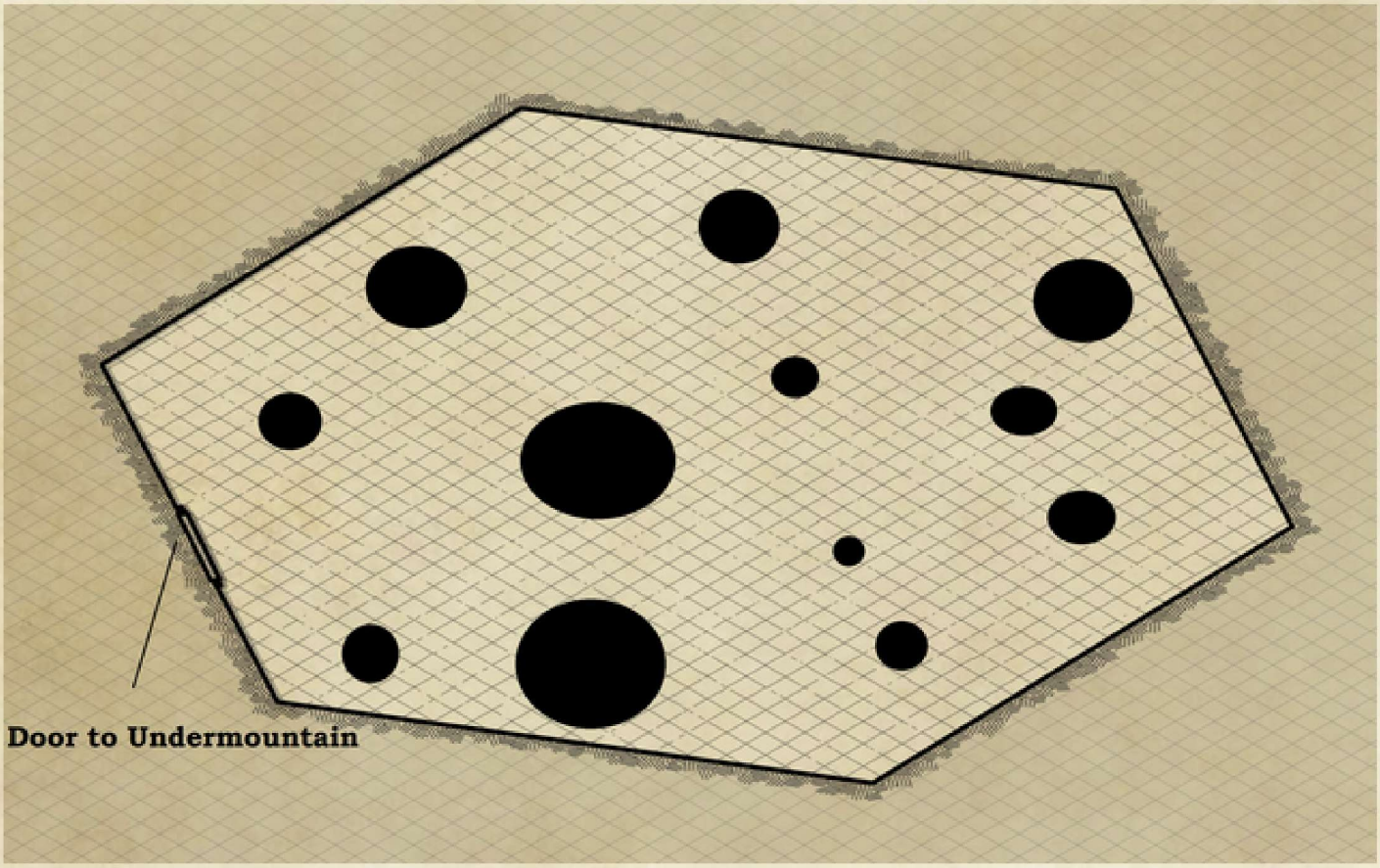
This expanded living space for the Myconid is accessible via Glitterhold's lift and several mine cart stations along the surface of Faerun.

50 Myconid Adults, 25 **Myconid Sprouts, 1 Myconid Sovereign** and **1d6 Myconid Inventors** make their home here. The idyllic lifestyle of the Myconids remains large unchanged afer their move down to the Undermountain, they simply have the opportunity to interact and cross-pollinate with more of their kind.

With assistance from Aeman, the Myconids have established trade relations with a few Undermountain factions. For a small tax, the Myconid happily allow non-sentient Undermountain trade goods to pass through their gates on the way up to the surface world.

All non-Myconid denizens reside in modular fungal housing (**Toadstool Tiny Homes**) or rent a room at the **Amanita Arms Inn**.

- At any given time at least 1d4 **Undermountain Mercenary** is kicking back at the **Toadstool Tavern** with a flagon of Shiitake Sherry waiting for an offer.
- 1d8 **Underdark Merchants** peddle goods from the under-kingdoms.
- On the weekends 1d12 **Skullport Mallrats** loiter and cause problems. Perhaps one or two of them could be whipped into shape as a **Sidekick**.
- The **Duregar food cart's** corndogs are very well-regarded
- **Rebellious Drow lovebirds** have been warned repeatedly about making out in the Beech Shroom groves.



Appendix E - Notes & Musings

- A player who wishes to tame an Aurumvorax can do so if they succeed on a **DC 20 Animal Handling** check and feed the Aurumvorax gems & precious metals worth at least 20 GP. Keeping the Aurumvorax happy, health and tamed will require feeding it at least 50 GP worth of precious metals and gems a day.
- Gary's Acid-Edged Short Sword is, in my opinion, the single best piece of treasure in this dungeon. Make sure your players don't forget about it if he is freed from his curse.
- Glitterhold is about a day's ride from Waterdeep. If the players keep it as a base feel free to let Aeman add a teleportation circle or magic doorway from the library to his lodgings in Waterdeep/Neverwinter/etc.
- Character's cursed with knowledge of the Mirror Dimension can take a **DC 15 Wisdom** saving throw after a long rest to sketch a design that came to them in a dream:

Mirror Technologies

All Mirror Technologies sketched out by players after a long rest can be crafted by skilled craftsmen for 2000 GP and one week of labor. All require attunement.

Any craftsmen who brings these technologies into existence will be cursed with knowledge of the Mirror Dimension and seek to bring its denizens to this plane of existence.

- **Dopple-Wristwatch:** A clockwork device in-laid with moonstones. Allows its wearer to cast *Mirror Image* 1/day. The duplicates bleed mercury when slain and do not vanish. They do not carry the caster's equipment. ***Requires fabrication by a skilled Artificer.***
- **Mirrorvein:** A polished shield. 1/day as a reaction to being targeted by an attack, a character carrying this shield can reduce their AC to 0. *If a character is not incapicated* after taking damage from the attack they can immediately deal an equal amount of damage to a creature within 5 ft. The shield functions as a *Shield +1*. ***Requires smithing by a skilled Blacksmith.***
- **Glass Switchblade:** A short wooden tube covered in runes, can be opened at one end and filled with sand. As an action a character can speak the command word and transform the sand within the tube into a jagged blade of polished glass. This object will *never* be identified as a weapon to an observer untrained in the mystical arts. The switchblade functions as a *Dagger +1*. The blade breaks on a critical fumble. ***Requires transmutation by a skilled Alchemist.***

Are these items balanced? Absolutely not. Feel free to keep them away from your tables and use your preferred magical items as Mirror Technology.

- Characters attuned to any Mirror Technology have disadvantage on saving throws made against attacks and effects from Mirror Dimension denizens.

Connecting Excavation of Glitterhold Gallery to other adventures:

This adventure module should be relatively easy to connect to other popular 5th edition content:

Sava Deepcups could easily be an acquaintance of Volothamp Geddarm or Gundren Rockseeker, providing a quick link to *Lost Mines of Phandelver* or *Waterdeep: Dragonheist.*

The Myconid Colony's link to the Underdark could lead the characters to get involved with the happenings of *Waterdeep: Dungeon of the Mad Mage.*

Any of the first editions potentially recovered from Aeman's library can be used to gain access to *Candlekeep Library.*

The treasure map in Aeman's chest can point to many of the adventures in *Tales from the Yawning Portal*, like the legendary *Sunless Citadel.*

Aeman Glitterhem will be affected by the death curse, providing a simple link to the events of *Tomb of Annhilation.*

While the vast majority of Aeman's wealth was lost with the passing of centuries, some banks on the worlds and realms outside of Toril are renown for maintaining accounts for *thousands* of years. Aeman has treasure squirreled away in banks on **The Rock of Braal** and **The Radiant Citadel.** He might have the party enrolled in *Spelljammer Academy* in order to help retrieve it.

Perhaps Aeman falls in with a bad crowd as he readjusts to modern life. He's lost a lot of gold bettng on losers in Waterdeep's illict Wild Hunts and enters the party as ringers.

Could any of the various cults sprinkled in amongst modules be worshippers of beings from the Mirror Dimension? Absolutely!

I am a huge fan of MCDM productions, especially their magazine *ARCADIA*. "The Workshop Watches" by Leon Barrillaro from issue 1 is one of my favorite adventures. I think it would function really well as a quest from Aeman to check up on one of his long untended properties & the project it houses.

CREDITS

- **Author:** Jay Rincher
- **Template:** Homebrewery
- All maps created with Dungeon Scrawl - seriosuly shout out to those devs. Their work really helped me bring this dungeon to life.
- **Special thanks to:** Everyone who provided feedback on this adventure, my Thusday Dice Night crew & my eternally patient wife.

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